
MAHARASHTRA CSR PORTAL

A Single Portal to Streamline CSR-Government Partnership Across the State

1. GUIDING PHILOSOPHY

Maharashtra does not yet have a single, unified CSR portal to streamline CSR projects across the State. This note sets out the design of such a portal. The single most important design principle is this: the portal must NOT feel like another layer of bureaucratic red tape. Corporates have many easier options for deploying their CSR funds; they will use this portal only if it is genuinely simpler, faster, and more rewarding than the alternatives.

The portal offers corporates a red-carpet experience: a dedicated CSR Relationship Manager as a single point of contact, guaranteed response times at every step, time-bound escalation so no request is ever ignored, a standard ready-to-use MoU, and full online tracking. Government comes to the corporate, not the other way around.

The portal has two clearly separated parts:

- The Static Part — a rich, public information resource that anyone can browse without logging in.
- The Dynamic Part — the working engine where corporates and government officials actually transact, coordinate, and track CSR projects through to completion.

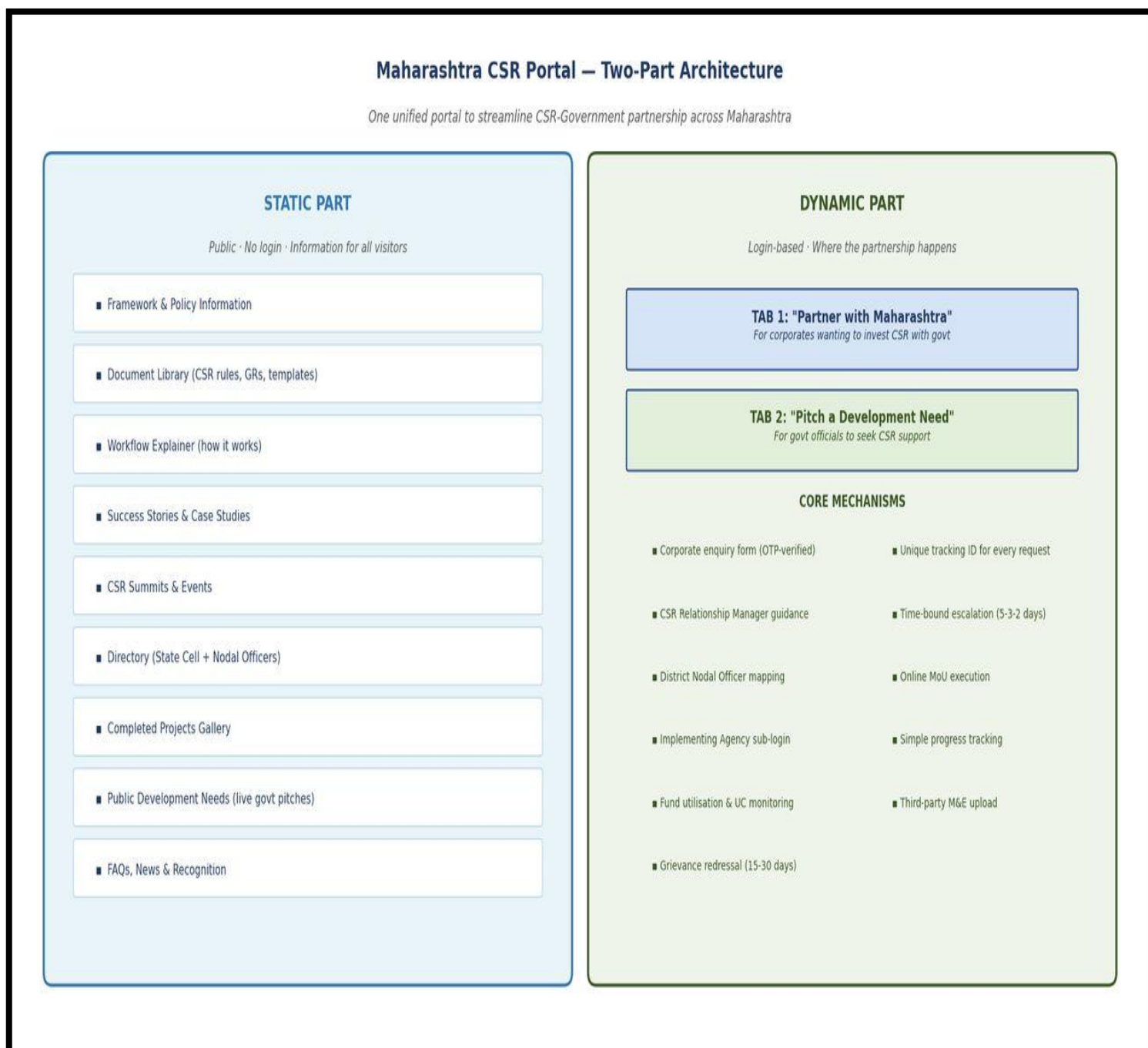


Figure 1: Two-Part Portal Architecture

2. THE COMPLETE PROCESS AT A GLANCE

The diagram presents the entire portal workflow on a single page both entry points (corporate and government), the time-bound escalations, and the common implementation and tracking flow into which both paths converge. This master view is intended to let the entire mechanism be understood in one look.

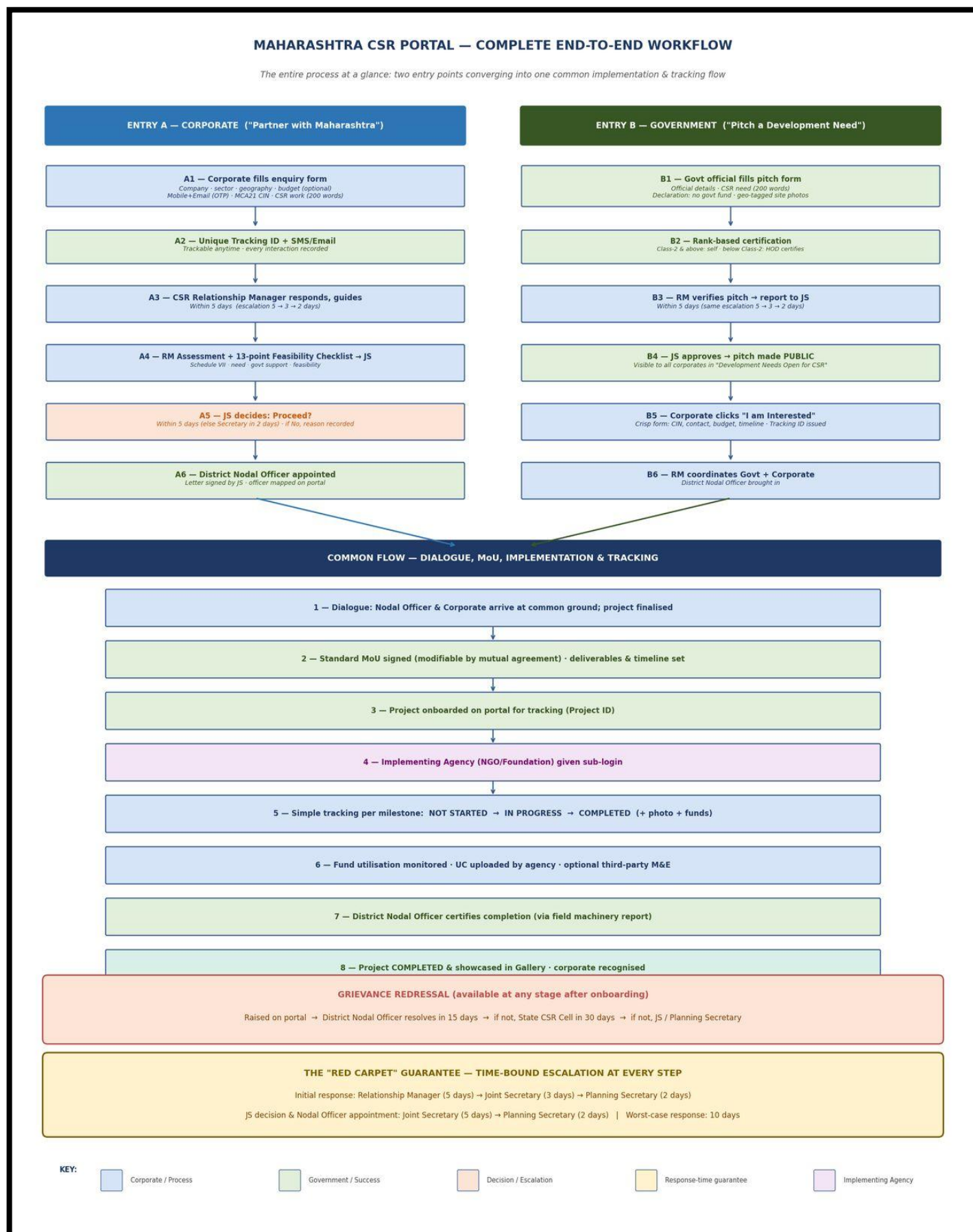


Figure 2: Maharashtra CSR Portal — Complete End-to-End Workflow

3. THE CSR RELATIONSHIP MANAGER

Because the entire system exists to win the confidence of corporates, the portal must look and feel corporate including in the language it uses. The official who guides each corporate through its journey is designated the CSR Relationship Manager. The term conveys exactly what the role is a dedicated professional who manages the corporate's relationship with the State end-to-end and evokes the premium, single-point-of-contact service corporates associate with quality.

The Department may alternatively consider Partnership Manager, CSR Engagement Manager, or CSR Concierge. Throughout this note the role is referred to as the CSR Relationship Manager (or simply Relationship Manager).

4. THE STATIC PART (Public Information)

The Static Part is visible to every visitor without any login. Its purpose is to be the single, complete, authoritative source of information on CSR-Government partnership in Maharashtra. It builds trust and answers questions before a corporate even decides to engage.

Section	What it Contains
Framework & Policy Information	The State's CSR convergence framework explained simply; benefits to corporates. Marathi & English.
Document Library	CSR Rules 2014 & MCA amendments; Schedule VII; State GRs; progress formats; checklists.
Workflow Explainer	Simple visual guide showing exactly how the partnership works, step by step, with timelines.
Success Stories & Case Studies	Completed projects with photos, investment, beneficiaries, corporate name. Builds confidence through proof.
CSR Summits & Events	Past summit reports and videos; upcoming events; registration links.
Directory	Contact details of the State CSR Cell, the CSR Relationship Managers, and all District Nodal Officers.
Completed Projects Gallery	Permanent, searchable public record of all portal projects — by district, sector, corporate, year.
Public Development Needs (Live)	Government pitches approved and made public — open for any corporate to fund.
FAQs, News & Recognition	Common questions; portal updates; CSR awards and recognition of corporate partners.

5. CORPORATE PARTNERSHIP JOURNEY (Partner with Maharashtra)

This is the heart of the portal — a hassle-free journey with a guaranteed response at every step and a single CSR Relationship Manager holding the corporate's hand throughout.

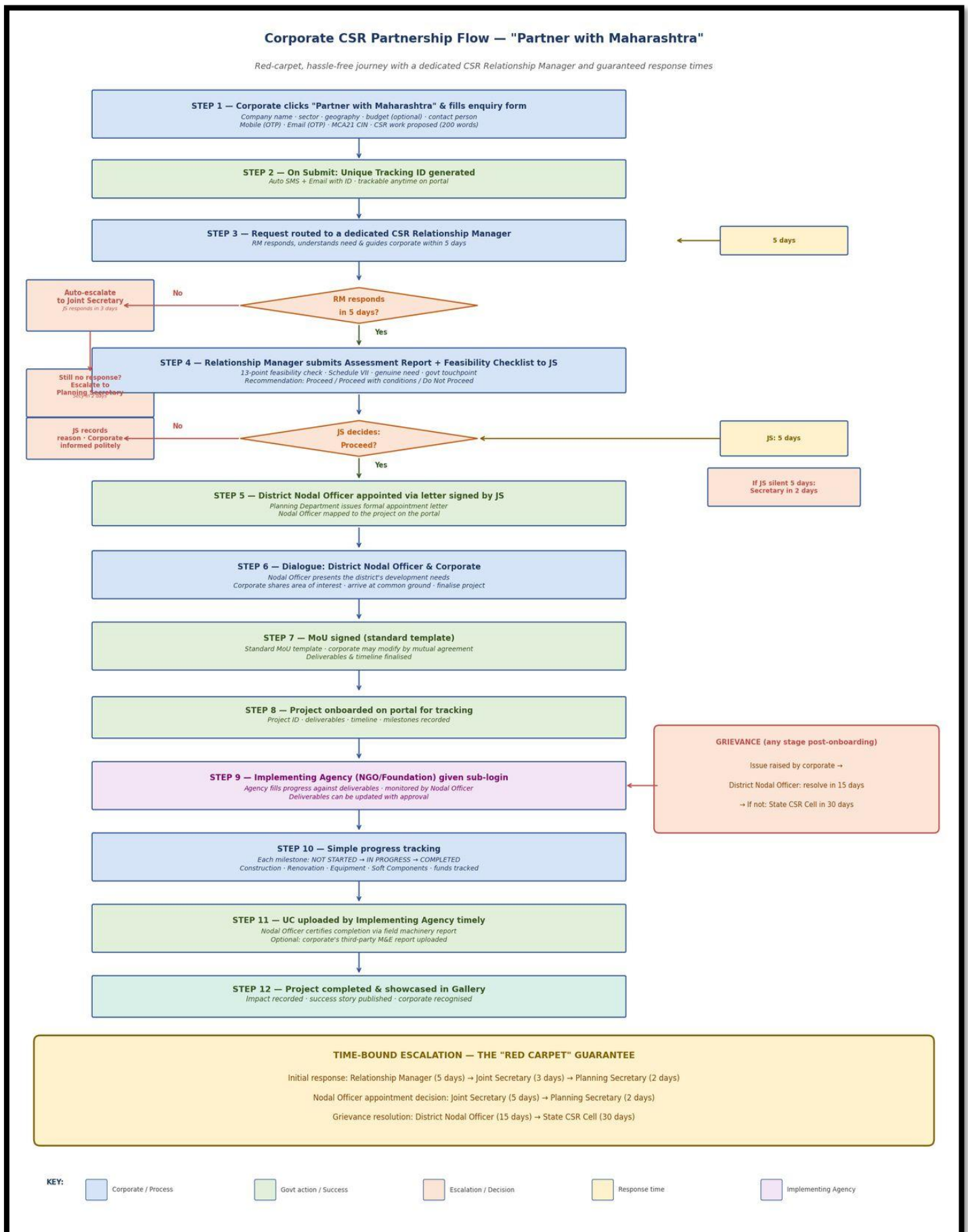


Figure 3: Corporate CSR Partnership Flow with Time-Bound Escalations

5.1 Step 1 — Corporate Enquiry Form

The corporate clicks Partner with Maharashtra and fills a simple, frictionless enquiry form:

Field	Description	Validation
Company Name	Registered name of the company	Mandatory
Sector	Industry sector	Dropdown, mandatory
Geography	Preferred district(s)/region	Multi-select, mandatory
Budget	Indicative CSR budget	Optional
Contact Person Name	CSR contact person	Mandatory
Mobile Number	Contact mobile	OTP verification
Email	Contact email	OTP verification
MCA21 CIN	Corporate Identity Number	Mandatory
Proposed CSR Work	What the corporate wants to do	Free text, max 200 words

5.2 Step 2 — Unique Tracking ID

- On submission, the portal instantly generates a Unique Tracking ID.
- Automated SMS and Email with the Tracking ID are sent to the corporate.
- The corporate can track live status anytime using this ID; every interaction is recorded against it.

5.3 Step 3 — CSR Relationship Manager Responds

The request is routed to a dedicated CSR Relationship Manager, who must respond, understand the need, and guide the corporate within 5 days.

Response Time (SLA): Relationship Manager responds within 5 days.

If no response...	Escalates to	Within
Relationship Manager silent 5 days	Joint Secretary	3 days
Joint Secretary silent 3 days	Planning Secretary	2 days

This time-bound escalation is the core of the red-carpet promise. No corporate enquiry can fall into a black hole — the system auto-escalates until answered, guaranteeing a response within at most 10 days even in the worst case.

5.4 Step 4 — Assessment Report + Feasibility Checklist to JS

After understanding the need, the Relationship Manager submits an Assessment Report to the Joint Secretary, including the 13-point Project Feasibility Checklist (Section 7 and Annexure A). This determines the go/no-go decision.

5.5 Step 5 — JS Decision & Nodal Officer Appointment

- If NOT proceeding: JS records the specific reason; the corporate is informed politely and guided to an alternative if possible.
- If proceeding: a District Nodal Officer is appointed via a formal letter issued by the Planning Department, signed by the JS, and mapped to the project on the portal.

Response Time (SLA): JS decides within 5 days. If the JS does not act within 5 days, it escalates to the Secretary, Planning Department, who decides within 2 days.

5.6 Steps 6-8 — Dialogue, MoU & Onboarding

- The District Nodal Officer presents the district's development needs; the corporate shares its area of interest; together they arrive at a common ground and finalise the project.
- A standard MoU (Annexure B) is signed; the corporate may modify it by mutual agreement; deliverables and timeline are finalised.
- The project is onboarded on the portal with a Project ID, and tracking begins.

6. IMPLEMENTATION, TRACKING & MONITORING

6.1 Implementing Agency Sub-Login

- Corporates implementing through their own NGO/foundation get a separate sub-login for that agency.
- The agency fills in progress against each deliverable; the District Nodal Officer monitors.
- Deliverables can be changed or updated (with Nodal Officer approval, recorded on the portal).
- The corporate creates the sub-login and remains accountable for the agency's actions.

6.2 Simple Progress Tracking

Progress tracking is kept deliberately simple. Every project, regardless of work type, has a list of milestones/deliverables (from the MoU). Each milestone carries just one of three plain statuses:

Status	Meaning
NOT STARTED	Work on this milestone has not yet begun
IN PROGRESS	Work on this milestone is underway
COMPLETED	This milestone is finished and verified

Against each milestone, the implementing agency also uploads a geo-tagged photo and records the funds utilised. That is the entire tracking interface — nothing more complex. The same simple format applies to all four work types:

Work Type	Example Milestones (each marked Not Started / In Progress / Completed)
Construction	Site ready · Foundation · Walls · Roof · Finishing · Handover
Renovation	Assessment · Repair work · Finishing · Handover
Purchase of Equipment	Order placed · Delivered · Installed · Accepted by institution
Soft Components	Plan ready · Activity conducted · Beneficiaries reached · Completed

Note: The milestones themselves are defined in the MoU for each project; the portal simply tracks the status of each. This keeps the corporate and agency experience clean and intuitive.

6.3 Fund Utilisation, UC & Third-Party M&E

- Fund utilisation is monitored against milestones; the agency records expenditure as work progresses.
- The Utilisation Certificate (UC) is uploaded by the implementing agency in a timely manner as deliverables complete.
- The District Nodal Officer certifies completion based on a report from their field machinery.
- The corporate may optionally engage an independent third party for monitoring & evaluation; the M&E report is uploaded on the portal.

7. PROJECT FEASIBILITY ASSESSMENT

The Relationship Manager's report to the JS must conclude whether a project is feasible. To ensure this rests on concrete, objective grounds rather than opinion, feasibility is decided through a 13-point checklist across six dimensions, with a clear decision rule.

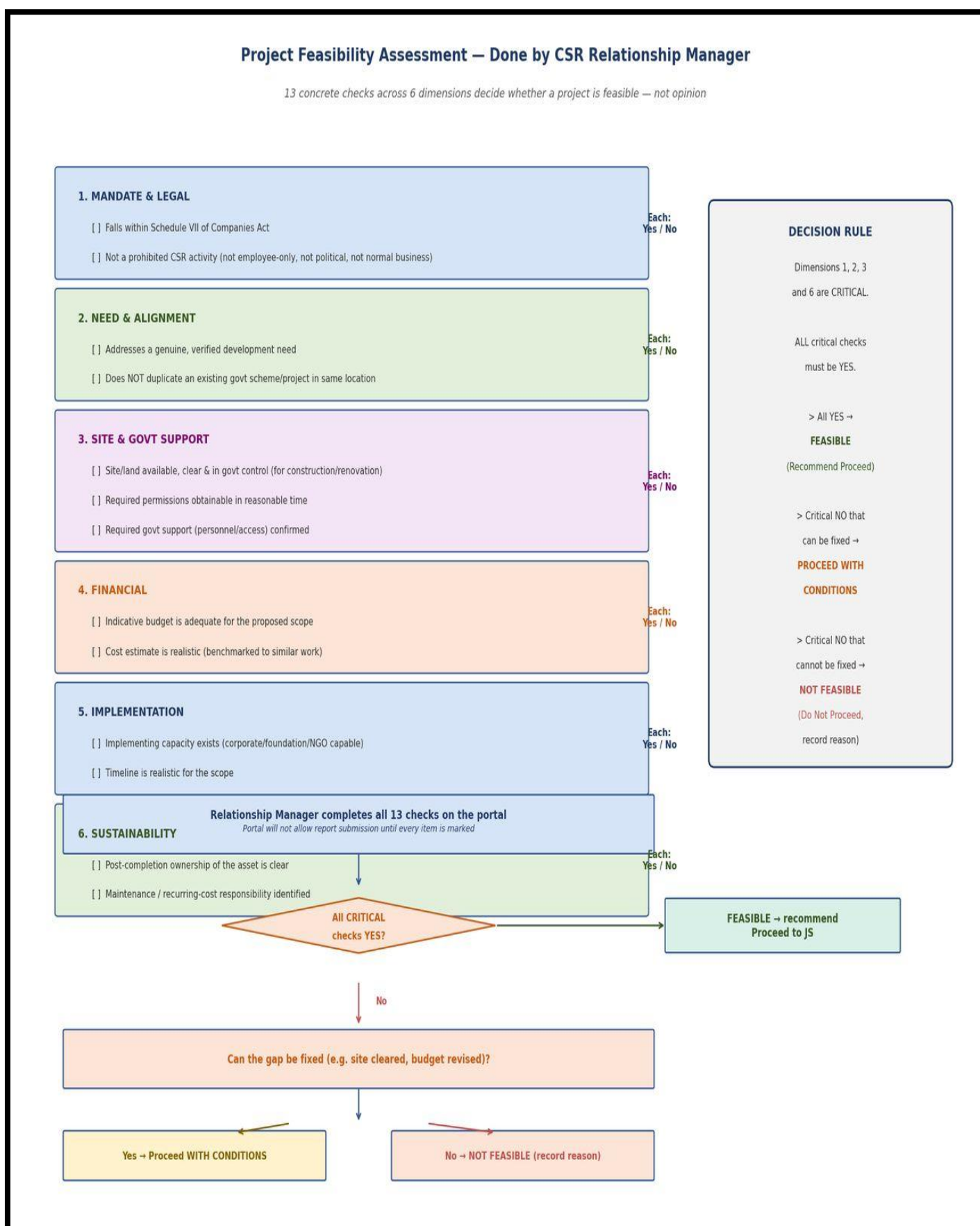


Figure 4: Project Feasibility Assessment — 13 Checks across 6 Dimensions

The full checklist appears in Annexure A. The decision rule is:

- All CRITICAL checks (Dimensions 1 Mandate & Legal, 2 Need & Alignment, 3 Site & Govt Support, 6 Sustainability) must be YES.
- All YES → FEASIBLE → recommend Proceed.
- A critical gap that can be fixed (e.g. site cleared, budget revised) → PROCEED WITH CONDITIONS.
- A critical gap that cannot be fixed → NOT FEASIBLE → Do Not Proceed, with reason recorded.

8. GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL MECHANISM

A simple, time-bound, two-level grievance mechanism ensures any issue raised during implementation is resolved quickly — essential to maintaining corporate trust.

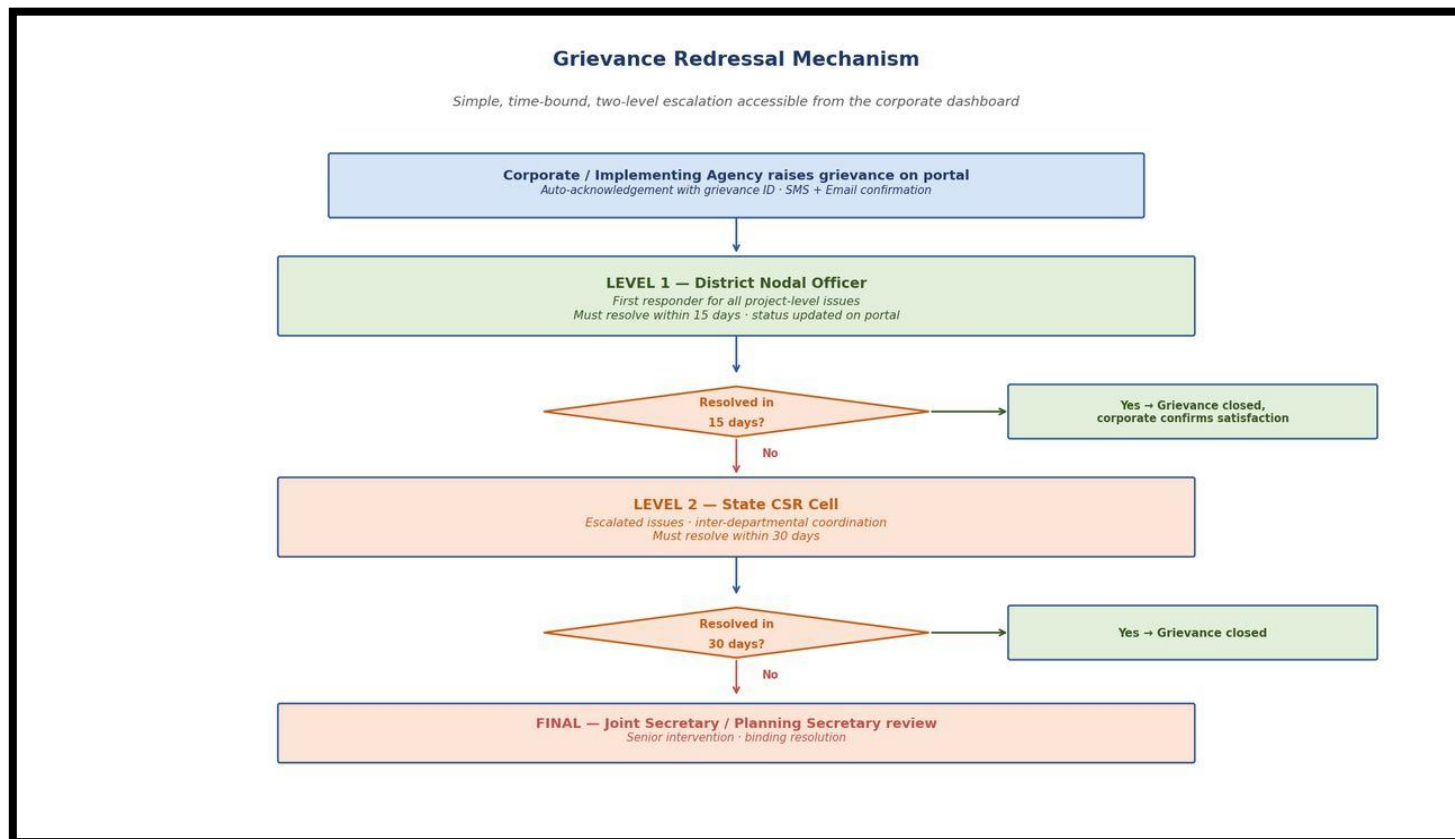


Figure 5: Grievance Redressal Mechanism

Level	Authority	Resolution Time	Scope
Raise	Corporate / Implementing Agency	Instant acknowledgement	Raised from dashboard; auto-acknowledgement with grievance ID via SMS + Email
Level 1	District Nodal Officer	15 days	First responder for all project-level issues
Level 2	State CSR Cell	30 days	Escalated if Nodal Officer does not resolve in 15 days; inter-departmental coordination
Final	JS / Planning Secretary	Senior review	For issues unresolved at Level 2; binding resolution

9. GOVERNMENT PITCH FLOW (Pitch a Development Need)

The second tab lets government officials pitch genuine, unfunded development needs for CSR support, populating the public list of opportunities corporates can choose to fund.

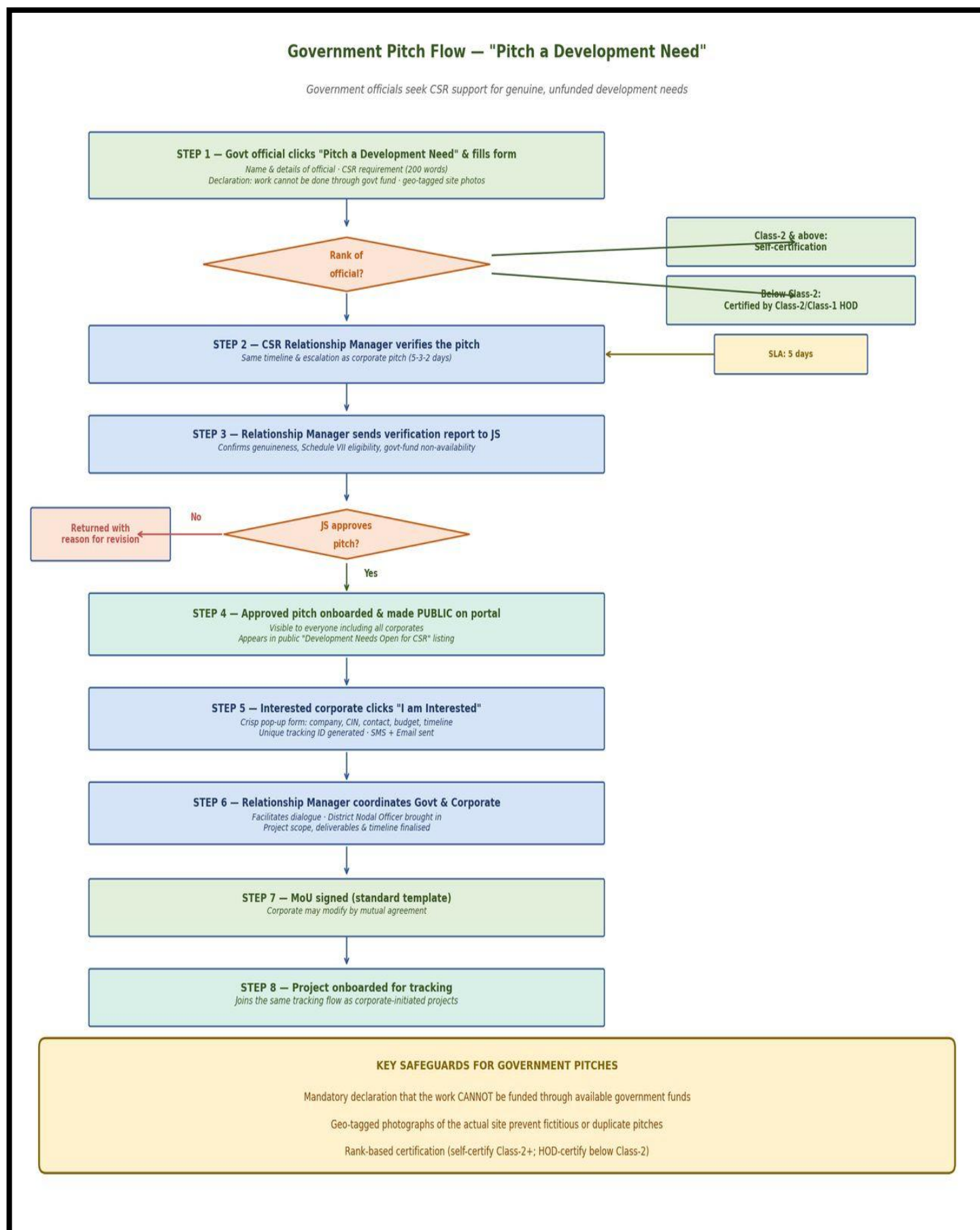


Figure 6: Government Pitch Flow

9.1 The Government Pitch Form

Field	Description	Validation
Name & Details of Official	Name, designation, department, office	Mandatory
Service Class	Class-1 / Class-2 / below Class-2	Mandatory
Mobile & Email	Contact details	OTP verification
District & Location	District, taluka, exact location	Mandatory
CSR Requirement	The development need	200 words max
Estimated Cost	Approximate cost	Mandatory
Govt Fund Declaration	Declaration that the work cannot be funded through available government funds	Mandatory declaration
Geo-tagged Site Photos	Photos of the actual site	Min 2, geo-tagged
Certification	Self (Class-2 & above) OR HOD certification (below Class-2)	Conditional on rank

9.2 Verification, Approval & Matching

- The Relationship Manager verifies the pitch (genuineness, Schedule VII eligibility, govt-fund non-availability). Same timeline & escalation as the corporate pitch (5-3-2 days).
- A verification report goes to the JS. On JS approval, the pitch is onboarded and made PUBLIC on the portal, visible to all corporates.
- An interested corporate clicks I am Interested and fills the crisp pop-up form (Section 9.3).
- The Relationship Manager coordinates between the government official and the corporate, brings in the District Nodal Officer, and on MoU signing the project is onboarded for tracking.

9.3 The I am Interested Pop-Up Form (crisp & to the point)

When a corporate clicks I am Interested on a public government pitch, a short pop-up form appears — only what is needed to start the conversation:

Field	Description	Validation
Pitch Reference ID	The ID of the pitch they are interested in	Auto-filled by portal
Company Name	Name of the interested corporate	Mandatory
MCA21 CIN	Corporate Identity Number	Mandatory
Contact Person & Designation	Who to coordinate with	Mandatory
Mobile Number	Contact mobile	OTP verification
Email	Contact email	OTP verification
Indicative Budget	How much CSR they can commit to this need	Mandatory
Preferred Start Timeline	When they would like to begin	Dropdown (this quarter / next quarter / this FY)
Implementation Mode	How they will implement	Self / Own Foundation / NGO Partner
Message to Government	Optional short note	Optional, max 100 words
Declaration	Genuine interest; authorise State CSR Cell to contact	Mandatory checkbox

Note: On submission, a Unique Tracking ID is generated and SMS + Email are sent, exactly as in the corporate enquiry flow. The Relationship Manager then coordinates between the two parties.

10. COMPLETE ESCALATION & RESPONSE-TIME SUMMARY

All response times are guaranteed and system-enforced. The portal tracks each timeline automatically and escalates when breached. (SLA simply means the guaranteed maximum response time for that step.)

Stage	Primary Responsible	Time	First Escalation	Second Escalation
Initial response to corporate enquiry	CSR Relationship Manager	5 days	Joint Secretary (3 days)	Planning Secretary (2 days)
Decision on report & Nodal Officer appointment	Joint Secretary	5 days	Planning Secretary (2 days)	—
Government pitch verification	CSR Relationship Manager	5 days	Joint Secretary (3 days)	Planning Secretary (2 days)
Grievance resolution	District Nodal Officer	15 days	State CSR Cell (30 days)	JS / Planning Secretary
Static helpdesk query	Helpdesk	2 days	—	—

Worst-case guarantee: a corporate enquiry receives a response within a maximum of 10 days even if every level misses its deadline, because the system auto-escalates. In practice, the vast majority are answered by the Relationship Manager within 5 days.

ANNEXURE A: ASSESSMENT REPORT + 13-POINT FEASIBILITY CHECKLIST

The Relationship Manager submits this to the Joint Secretary after engaging with the corporate. It is generated on the portal and is the basis of the go/no-go decision.

A.1 Assessment Report Format

Field	Content
Report Reference & Date	Auto-generated
Corporate Tracking ID	Unique ID from enquiry
Company Name & CIN	MCA21-verified
Sector & Contact (verified)	From enquiry form, OTP-verified
Proposed CSR Work (summary)	Relationship Manager's summary
Proposed Location / District	Where the corporate wants to work
Indicative Budget	If provided
Development Need Addressed	The genuine, verified need the project addresses
Date of First Contact	Confirms the 5-day response time was met
Summary of Interaction	Brief record of the dialogue
Feasibility Result	FEASIBLE / PROCEED WITH CONDITIONS / NOT FEASIBLE (from A.2)
Recommendation	Proceed / Proceed with conditions / Do Not Proceed, with reasons
Suggested Nodal Officer Domain	e.g. Education Officer, District Health Officer, Executive Engineer

A.2 13-Point Project Feasibility Checklist

Every item must be marked. The portal will not allow report submission until all are completed. Critical dimensions are marked [C].

#	Dimension	Check	Answer
1	Mandate & Legal [C]	Activity falls within Schedule VII of the Companies Act	Yes / No
2	Mandate & Legal [C]	Not a prohibited CSR activity (not employee-only, not political, not normal course of business)	Yes / No
3	Need & Alignment [C]	Addresses a genuine, verified development need	Yes / No
4	Need & Alignment [C]	Does NOT duplicate an existing government scheme or ongoing project in the same location	Yes / No
5	Site & Govt Support [C]	For construction/renovation: site/land is available, clear, and in government ownership/control	Yes / No / NA
6	Site & Govt Support [C]	Required permissions/clearances are obtainable within a reasonable time	Yes / No

#	Dimension	Check	Answer
7	Site & Govt Support [C]	Required government support (personnel, access) is confirmed	Yes / No
8	Financial	Indicative budget is adequate for the proposed scope	Yes / No
9	Financial	Cost estimate is realistic (benchmarked against similar works)	Yes / No
10	Implementation	Implementing capacity exists (corporate/foundation/NGO is capable)	Yes / No
11	Implementation	Timeline is realistic for the scope	Yes / No
12	Sustainability [C]	Post-completion ownership of the asset is clear	Yes / No
13	Sustainability [C]	Maintenance / recurring-cost responsibility is identified	Yes / No

Decision Rule

- All CRITICAL [C] checks (items 1-7, 12, 13) must be YES for the project to be FEASIBLE.
- All checks YES → FEASIBLE → recommend Proceed.
- A critical gap that can be resolved → PROCEED WITH CONDITIONS (state the condition).
- A critical gap that cannot be resolved → NOT FEASIBLE → Do Not Proceed, record the reason.

ANNEXURE B: STANDARD MoU TEMPLATE

The standard MoU used for all CSR convergence projects, pre-loaded on the portal. Corporates may propose changes, incorporated by mutual agreement before signing.

MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING

for CSR Convergence Project under the Maharashtra CSR Portal

This MoU is entered into on _____ day of _____, 20____, by and between:

(1) The [District/Department], Government of Maharashtra, represented by the District Nodal Officer, [Name & Designation] (the Government Party);

(2) [Corporate Name], a company incorporated under the Companies Act, CIN [____], office at [____] (the Corporate Partner); and

Clause 1 — Purpose and Scope

The Corporate Partner shall undertake the following CSR project in convergence with the Government Party: [Project Title and description]. The project falls under Schedule VII clause [____] of the Companies Act, 2013.

Clause 2 — Project Location

The project shall be implemented at [exact location: institution/village/ward, taluka, district].

Clause 3 — Deliverables and Timeline

Agreed deliverables, milestones, and timeline are in Schedule I. The project shall be completed within [____] months from signing, unless extended by mutual written agreement recorded on the portal.

Clause 4 — Financial Contribution

The Corporate Partner shall contribute CSR funds of approximately Rs. [____]. Proper accounts shall be maintained and Utilisation Certificates provided as deliverables are completed.

Clause 5 — Government Party's Contribution

The Government Party shall provide [land / building / site access / permissions / personnel, as applicable] per Schedule II, in a timely manner so as not to delay implementation.

Clause 6 — Implementation

The project shall be implemented by [the Corporate Partner directly / the Implementing Agency on its behalf]. The Implementing Agency shall record progress against deliverables on the portal.

Clause 7 — Monitoring

The District Nodal Officer and the Corporate Partner shall monitor the project on the portal using the standard progress format. The Corporate Partner may engage an independent third party for M&E, whose report shall be uploaded on the portal.

Clause 8 — Utilisation Certificate

The Implementing Agency / Corporate Partner shall upload UCs on the portal as deliverables complete. The District Nodal Officer shall certify completion based on field verification.

Clause 9 — Ownership and Maintenance

On completion, the asset shall be owned by [the Government institution/department]. Ongoing operation and maintenance shall vest with [named entity] per Schedule II.

Clause 10 — Changes to Deliverables

Deliverables may be modified by mutual written agreement, recorded on the portal with the District Nodal Officer's approval.

Clause 11 — Grievances

Issues shall be resolved through the portal's grievance mechanism: District Nodal Officer (15 days), escalating to the State CSR Cell (30 days).

Clause 12 — Recognition

The Government Party shall recognise the Corporate Partner through Success Stories, the Completed Projects Gallery, and applicable CSR awards.

Clause 13 — Term and Termination

Valid until project completion and final UC. May be terminated by mutual agreement, or by either Party with [30] days' notice for valid cause, settling obligations for work already done.

Clause 14 — Dispute Resolution

Disputes shall be resolved amicably through the State CSR Cell; failing which, subject to the jurisdiction of courts in the relevant district in Maharashtra.

Clause 15 — General

This MoU is entered in good faith for public benefit. It creates no commercial relationship and does not obligate the Corporate Partner beyond its voluntary CSR commitment.

For the Government Party: _____ For the Corporate Partner: _____ For the
Implementing Agency: _____